

THE PROXY

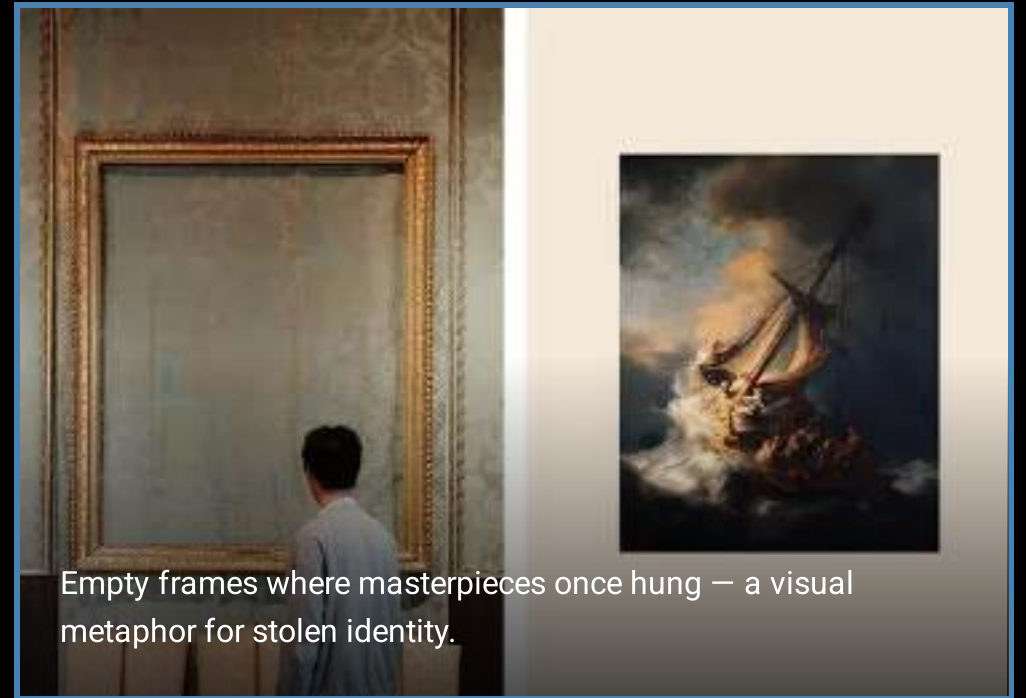
When they mistook her for a powerful woman, she played along to survive. Now she's taking it all back.

Created by: Kelly R. Tenney

LOGLINE

When a **struggling single mother** is mistaken for a **high-profile art dealer** during a violent gallery heist, she plays along to stay alive.

But when she learns the real woman orchestrated it all, **Monique** must infiltrate the art world's underbelly to expose the truth—and reclaim the identity that was nearly stolen forever.



Empty frames where masterpieces once hung — a visual metaphor for stolen identity.

TONE & GENRE

Thriller meets Intimate Drama

- A psychological identity thriller with the emotional richness of a coming-into-power journey.
- Grounded romance woven through a mother-son survival story.
- Social legacy tension— art, Black identity, and cultural theft in a post-viral world.

THINK:



Killing Eve *meets* **The Undoing**



Queen & Slim *meets* **Inside Man**



A splash of **The Crown** *meets* **Atlanta**

WHAT IT'S ABOUT

THE PROXY is about:



Stolen identity and **stolen art**



Power from invisibility



A woman using the **illusion of status** to reclaim her truth



Legacy, authenticity, and who gets to tell the story



Revenge wrapped in elegance



It's a survival story, a social reckoning, and a slow-burn character transformation—with heart, teeth, and paintbrushes.

CHARACTER PROFILES

MONIQUE DAVENPORT

Our Hero



- 33. Black. A waitress. A mother. An artist with no name on the wall.
- Sharp. Resourceful. Tired of just surviving.
- Untrained but brilliant painter—her art is raw, intuitive, deeply personal.
- Her relationship with her son grounds her. But now she must lie to protect them both.

"From Impostor to Architect of Her Own Power."

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BIANCA ST. JAMES

The Mirror



- 40s. Black. A luxury gallery owner with cartel connections and impeccable taste.
- Powerful, cold, calculating.
- Built her empire stealing art—and identities—from women like Monique.
- She didn't mistake Monique. She chose her.

"She is what Monique might have been—if the world hadn't decided otherwise."

THEMES

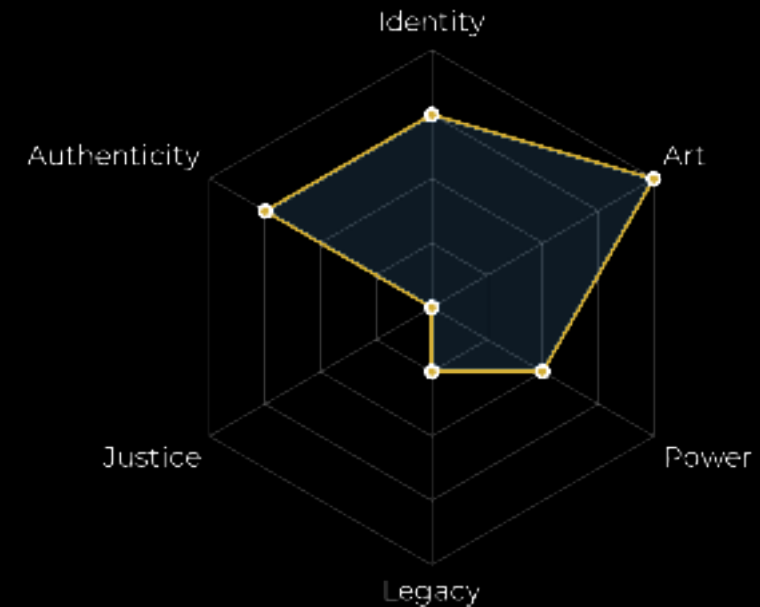
Art as Identity. Legacy as Leverage.

- ? *Who owns the story?*
- ? *What happens when a Black woman steals back what was taken?*
- ? *How do we fight the systems that erase us—without becoming them?*

Explores:

-  Cultural theft & repatriation
-  Single motherhood & Black creativity

-  Digital mythology, social media spectacle
-  Power, wealth, erasure, and revenge



WORLD & VISUAL STYLE

Atlanta.

Gentrified art galleries. Historic Black neighborhoods. Corporate glitz meets street hustle.



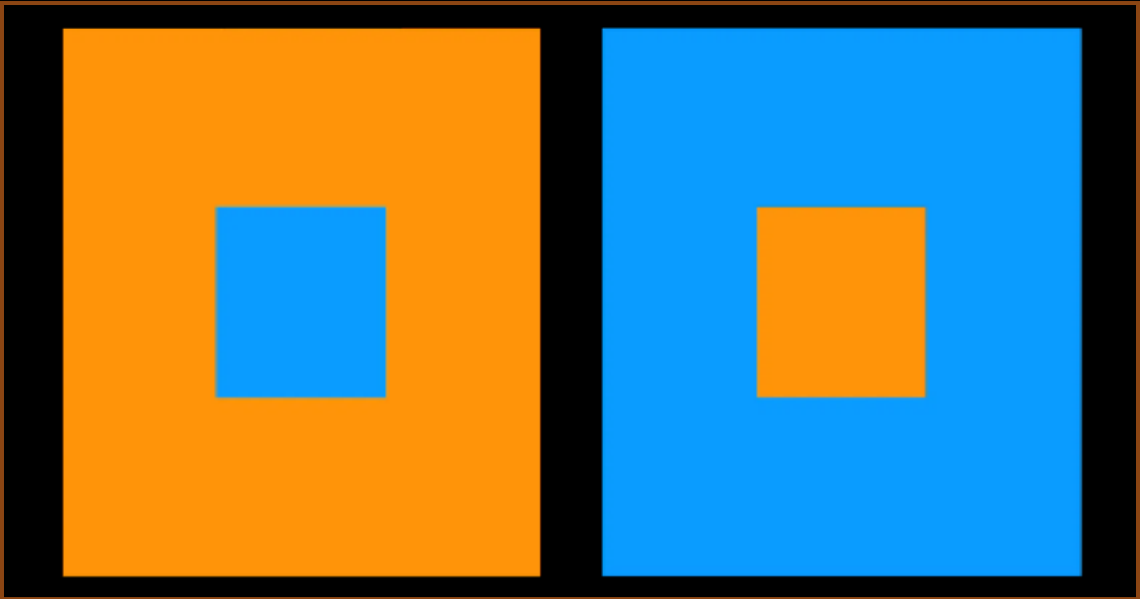
Visual Contrast

Monique's World:

Warm colors — texture, clutter, life.

Bianca's World:

Cold minimalism — sterility, luxury, curated danger.



Visual style transitions from warm to cool as Monique navigates between worlds

Camera & Tone:

Handheld intimacy transitions into **elegant framing** as Monique gains power.

Close-ups linger on paint, skin, expression, breath.

Digital overlays, social feeds, security footage heighten tension & identity blur.

ROMANCE THREAD

Monique & Jordan Rivers

A reluctant partnership becomes emotional friction. Their connection evolves from suspicion to trust, and ultimately to something deeper.

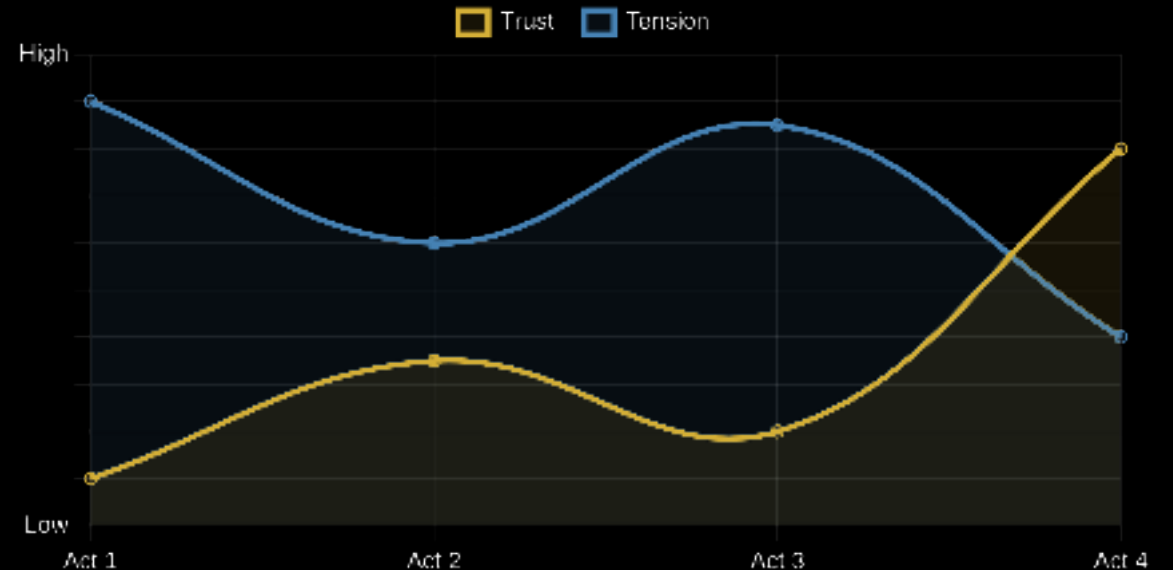
- ◆ He's an ex-cop turned fixer who once worked for Bianca.
- ◆ Trust is hard-earned, tension-filled, and always walking a knife's edge.
- ◆ Their love story is less about rescue—and more about **awakening**.

II

You're not her replacement. You're her reckoning.

— Jordan to Monique

Relationship Evolution



FORMAT & STRUCTURE

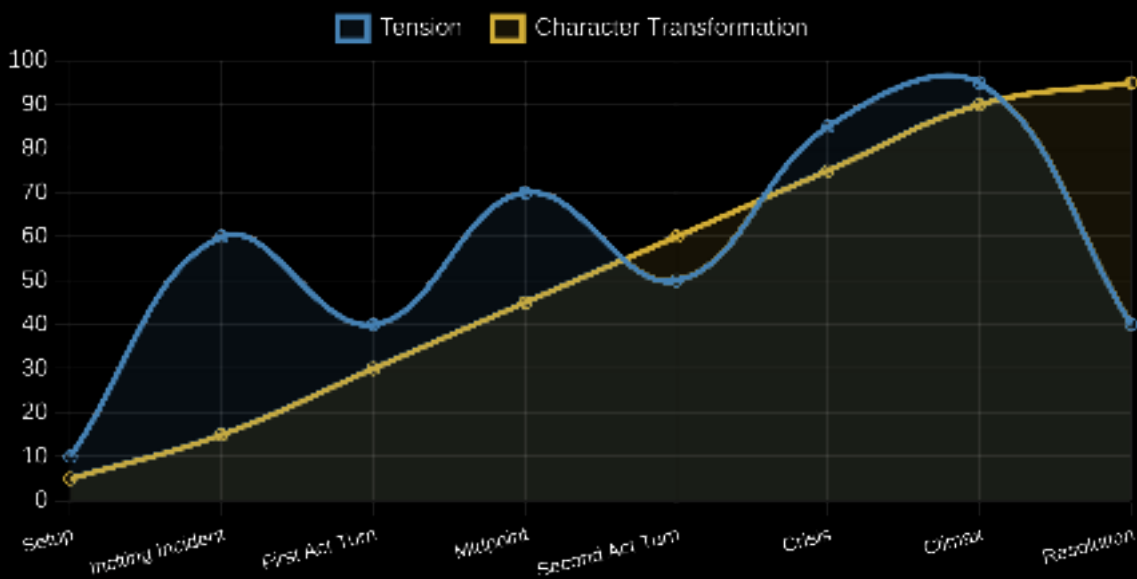
Feature Film

Runtime: 100–110 minutes

Structure: Thriller with act breaks

Pacing: Slow-burn with escalating tension

Narrative Arc



* Chart shows tension and character transformation across the film's runtime

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Act Structure

- ACT I

The Mistaken Identity

Monique is mistaken for Bianca during a gallery heist. She plays along to survive, discovering a world of luxury and power she never had access to.
- ACT II

The Infiltration

Learning Bianca orchestrated the mistaken identity, Monique partners with Jordan to infiltrate the art world and uncover the truth behind Bianca's scheme.
- ACT III

The Revelation

Monique discovers Bianca has been stealing and selling her artwork for years. Their confrontation reveals deeper connections between them than either knew.
- ACT IV

The Reclamation

Monique turns the tables, using Bianca's own tactics against her to reclaim her identity, her art, and forge a new path forward on her own terms.

AUDIENCE & MARKET FIT

For fans of:

- Sharp Objects
- Killing Eve
- I May Destroy You
- The Undoing
- Queen & Slim

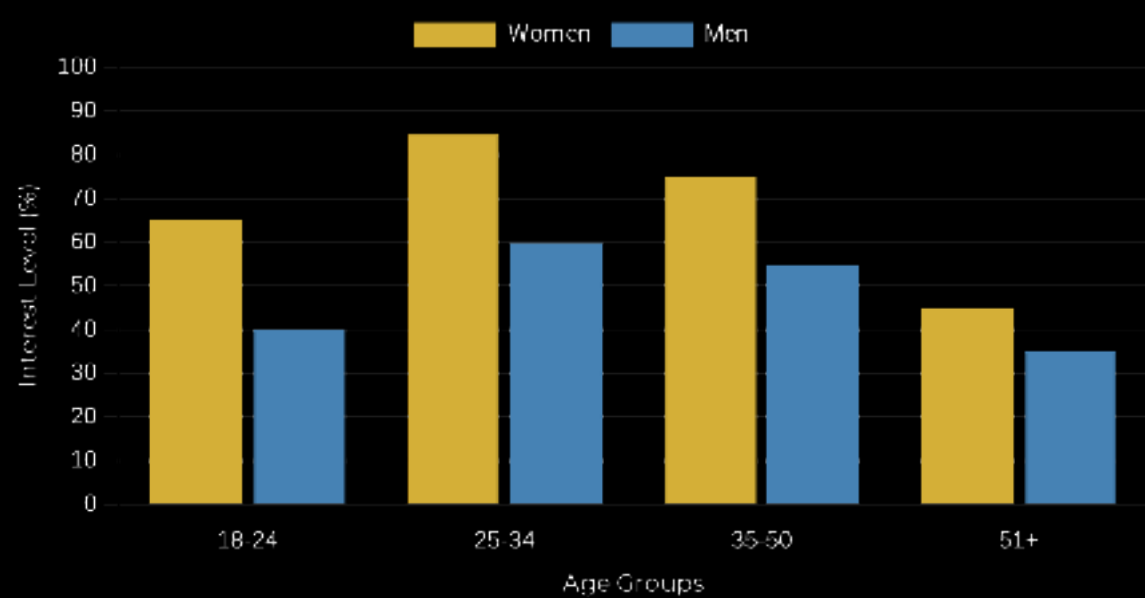
Target Audience:

- Women 25–50
- BIPOC creators and social justice thinkers
- True crime + art world enthusiasts
- Viewers seeking elevated, character-driven thrillers with emotional depth

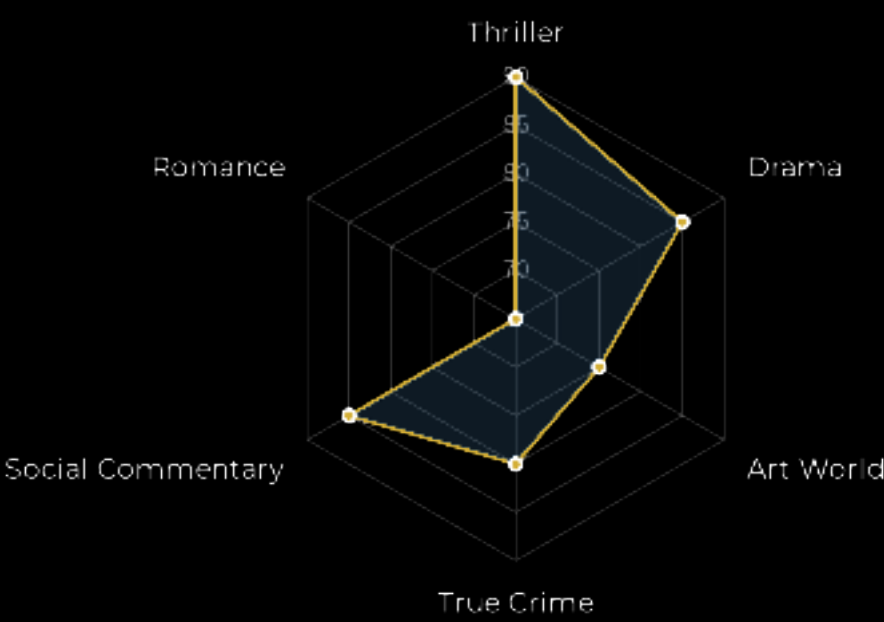
POTENTIAL PLATFORMS

- HBO
- Netflix
- Amazon Prime
- Hulu
- Peacock

Audience Demographics



Genre Interest Overlap



WHY NOW



Cultural theft and appropriation are center-stage globally.



Black stories about identity, survival, and artistry have mainstream power.



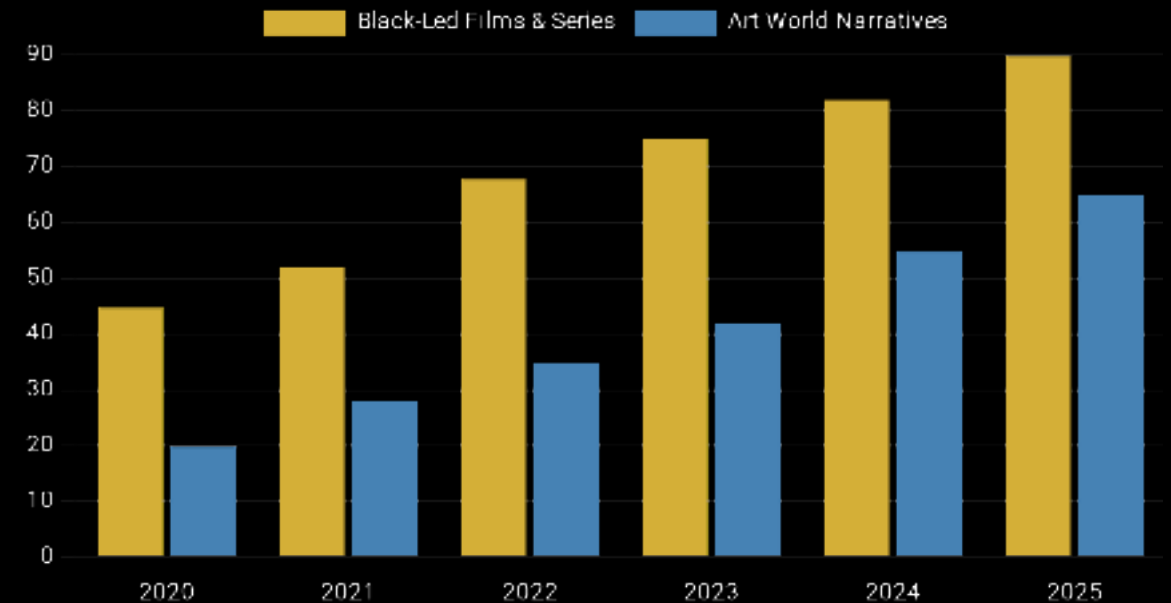
"Mistaken identity" narratives are ripe for social and emotional subversion.



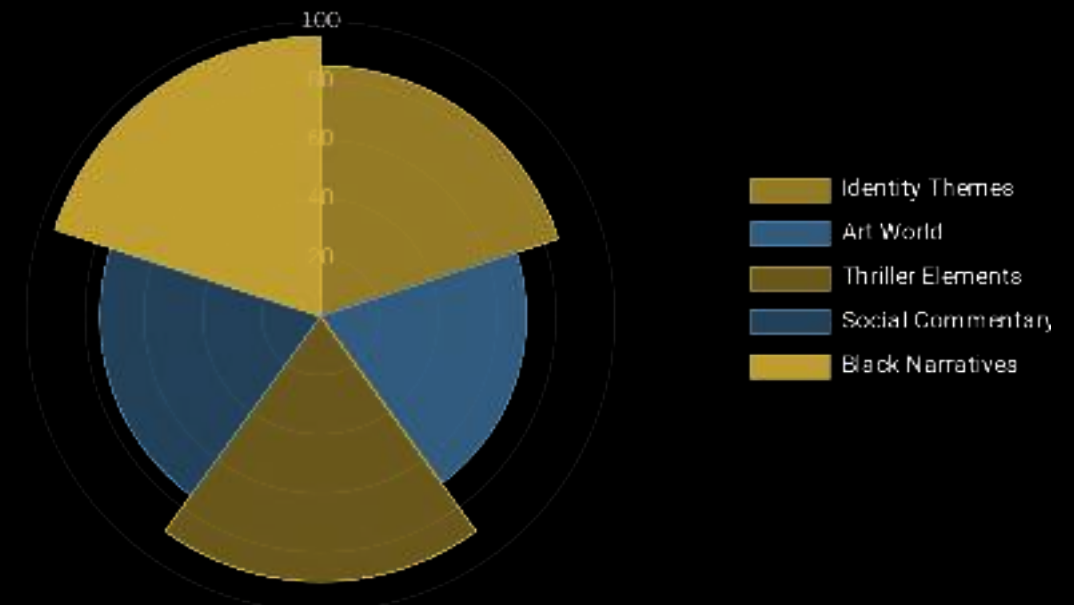
The Proxy speaks to **modern erasure**—and what it takes to be seen.

A story that resonates with audiences seeking authentic representation and complex narratives about power, identity, and justice.

Rising Cultural Trends



Audience Interest by Theme



PRODUCTION NOTES

🎬 Tone & Rating

R for thematic intensity, adult language, and violence

📍 Setting

Modern-day **Atlanta**

🎨 Visual Style

Prestige, elevated, art-forward

👤 Casting

Lead roles ideal for powerhouse talent—flexible for big-name or breakout actress



Budget Allocation Priority



FRANCHISE POTENTIAL

Beyond the Feature Film: Expanding **THE PROXY** Universe



Anthology Series

Each season follows a different stolen identity, legacy battle, or cultural theft narrative.



Docu-style Companion

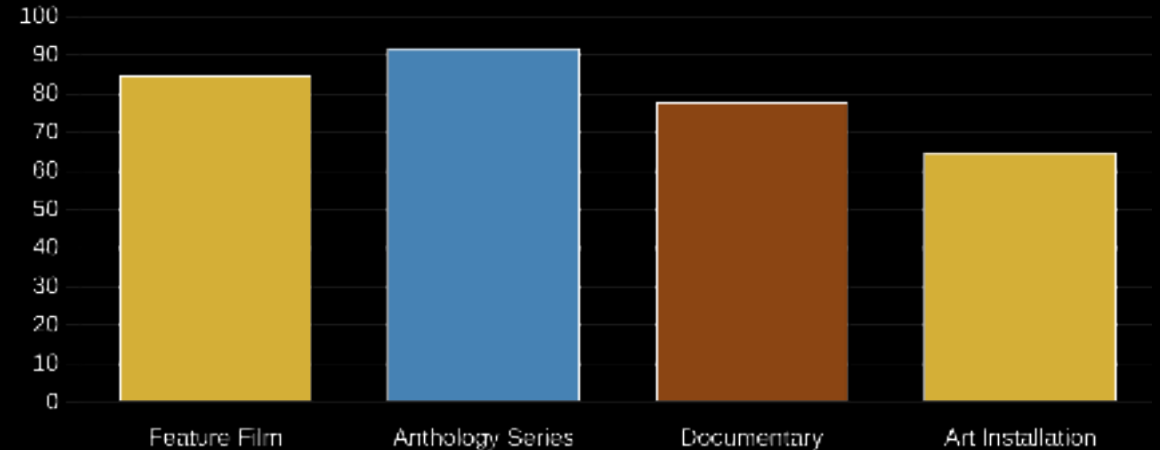
Real stories of repatriated art, forged identity, and exploitation that inspired the fictional narrative.



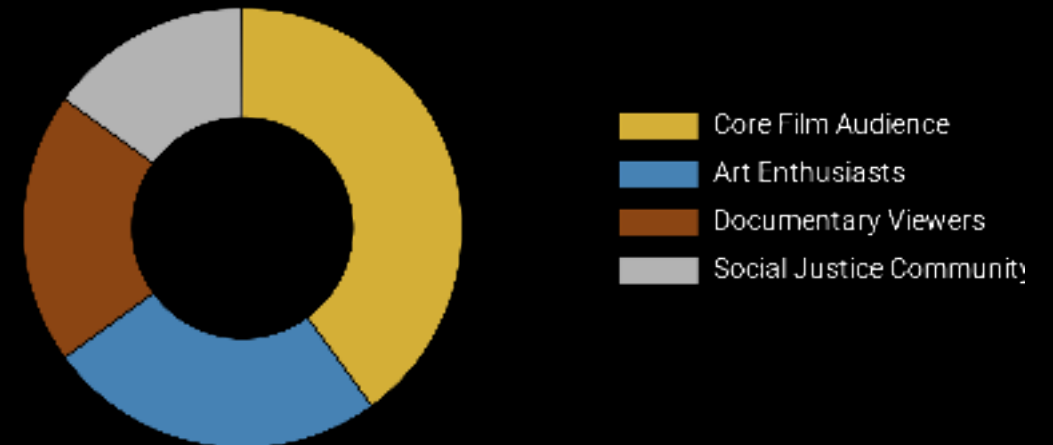
Art Exhibit / Installation

Partner with Black visual artists to exhibit "reclaimed works" from the story.

Franchise Format Potential



Audience Expansion Opportunities



FINAL IMAGE + TAGLINE

Poster Concept:

Monique, framed by gallery lighting. Behind her—masked intruders. Beside her—her own stolen painting, signed by someone else.

- **Visual Contrast:** Warm lighting on Monique against cold, sterile gallery background
- **Composition:** Monique centered but slightly off-balance, suggesting her precarious position
- **Symbolism:** Empty frames and shadowy figures represent stolen identity and art
- **Typography:** Bold, elegant font with gold accents reflecting the art world's luxury

**They stole her face.
She's taking back
everything else.**

